

1. Sample 1 of water froze at 0°C .
2. Sample 2 of water froze at 0°C .
3. Sample 3 of water froze at 0°C .
-
- N. Sample N of water froze at 0°C .
- N+1. If all past samples of water froze at 0°C , then
this sample of water will freeze at 0°C .
-
- C. This sample of water will freeze at 0°C . (1-N+1)

Is this argument valid?

We already have an explanation of why we should believe premises 1-N.

What about premise $N+1$?

In our first reading, Hume addresses the question of whether we should believe premises like this by drawing a distinction between two different kinds of claims:

Premise N+1 appears to be like the claim that the sun will rise tomorrow:
it is a matter of fact rather than a matter of the relations of ideas, and so
cannot be known "by the mere operation of thought."

$N+1$. If all past samples of water froze at 0°C , then this sample of water will freeze at 0°C .

The Uniformity of Nature

The future will be like the past.

It seems as though, if we should believe in the Uniformity of Nature, we should believe $N+1$. So the basic question is whether we should believe in the Uniformity of Nature.

Is the negation of this claim a contradiction?

It seems not. So it seems that, if we should believe it, we must believe it
on the basis of experience.

Well, why do we believe in the Uniformity of Nature? Simply because, in the past, the future has always been like the past. Yesterday the future was like the past. And the same for the day before that. And this suggests an argument for the Uniformity of Nature:

1. Yesterday, the future was like the past.
 2. The day before yesterday, the future was like the past.
 3. The day before the day before yesterday, the future was like the past.
 -
 - N. N days ago, the future was like the past.
-
- C. Today, the future will be like the past.
(1-N)

Is this argument valid?

What extra premise would make the argument valid?

It is hard to see how we could make the argument valid without adding a premise which was just a restatement of the very claim — the Uniformity of Nature — which we were trying to prove.

We already have an explanation of why we should believe premises 1-N.

What about premise $N+1$?

kindest of claims:

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N.N days ago, the future was like the past.

likethepast.

C. Today, the future will be like the past.

1.Yesterday, the future was like the past.



2. The day before yesterday, the future was



3. The day before the day before yesterday;

the future was like the past.



After all, yesterday the future was like the past. And the same for the day

before that. And this suggests an argument for the Uniformity of Nature.



the past.



N.N days ago, the future was like the past.

3. The day before the day before yesterday, the

future was like the past.

C. Today, the future will be like the past. (I-N)

2. The day before yesterday, the future was like

1. Yesterday, the future was like the past.









































































































































































































































































































at the air.

All massinv objects



Every 24 hours, the earth

rotates in its axis.

present no explanation of this fact. After all, the only arguments we can give for the

claims will be arguments like our argument that the sun will come up tomorrow. And

It is very plausible that these are all claims which we should believe. But we have at

these arguments are invalid, and hence not good arguments. This seems to show that

Foundationalism, as we have formulated it, is false.



irreairthi in 2061.

Hailey's concert will next be visible

It also raises an important question. We think that at least some scientific theories are

theories should believe, and that other generalizations are not. Consider, for example,



are more likely to be stolen than

People born under the sign of Taurus

people born under other signs.

because one shouldn't believe the theory. But why not?

This is a prediction of the theory of astrology. One shouldn't believe this prediction

It is tempting to say something like: there's no good argument for astrology; there's no

reason to think that it is true.

















































































































































































































































































